

Crop Yield Prediction

NAGISETTI GEETHA SREE

School of Electronics

Engineering (SENSE)

Vellore Institute of Technology

Vellore, India-632014

nagiseti.geetha2023@vitstudent.ac.in

Abstract—Accurate and timely crop yield prediction is one of the most important components of modern agricultural management, helping to improve resource allocation, reduce the threats associated with food security, and inform policy for better decision-making against increasing climate changes. In fact, most traditional methods of predicting crop yield hardly keep up with rapidly changing environmental conditions and therefore pose a significant challenge in making accurate predictions. This paper explores the potential of machine learning models for crop yield prediction in addressing these kinds of complications with a focus on recent works (2023–2025). We used four variant machine learning methods: Random Forest Regression Algorithm, Gradient Boosting for ensemble learning, Feature Engineering and Selection and Cross-validation and hyperparameter tuning. [1]. Using Random Forest Regression Algorithm our project modifies the environmental factors like temperature, humidity and wind speed along with variables that find soil quality through pH levels and specific crop characteristics. We developed the entire solution on an AWS infrastructure which has an easily accessible web dashboard that is scalable and user friendly. Performance measures of our model are highly accurate with a high R^2 value of 97.5% and RMSE of 4.1, ensuring efficiency for major crops like rice, wheat and corn. Our research provides an accessible and highly accurate model that makes decisions based on the data given which reduces the agricultural risks and also improve resource sustainability.

Keywords— Machine Learning, Crop Yield Prediction, Random Forest Regression, Gradient Boosting, Precision Agriculture, Environmental Factors, Soil Quality, Feature Engineering, AWS Infrastructure, R^2 , RMSE, Food Security, Agricultural Management, Climate Change.

I. INTRODUCTION

A. Background and Motivation

Agriculture is the backbone of food security worldwide but it always faces a threat from variable climate changes, depletion of the resources and inefficient traditional practices.

There are many challenges like predicting the crop yield accurately because these predictions have an impact on the economic stability of farmers and efficiency in planning food supply chains worldwide. In the recent years, we have seen a lot of interest in applying machine learning techniques to enhance the efficiency and reliability of crop yield predictions. Traditional methods often use ways that are supported by field analysis that are done manually which have less accuracy and fail to consider complex real time changes related to environmental factors.

B. Problem Statement and Objectives

Our main focus is on the central problem that is the lack of an accessible, highly accurate and cloud-based AI for finding multi parameter data on crop yield prediction. Most of the already existing models involve high cost and don't have cloud access. They also fail to provide accurate prediction that is necessary to make major farming decisions.

The objectives of this project are:

1. Develop an ML powered prediction system: Design and implement an efficient machine learning model based on Random Forest Regression Algorithm which should be capable to predict the yield of crops like rice, wheat, barley, corn and soybean with at least 97.5% accuracy that is given by the R^2 score and RMSE of 4.1.
2. Design a Cloud based interactive dashboard: Develop a user friendly and scalable web board using AWS Cloud Services (EC2 and S3) and the Gradio interface so that the farmers can view real time yield predictions and AI recommended actions.
3. Integrate multi parameter analysis: Use advanced analysis of environmental conditions like temperature, humidity and wind speed with soil quality using pH levels for optimization strategies.

C. Scope and Relevance

The scope of this project is to deploy a predictive ML based model for five major crops i.e. rice, wheat, corn, barley and soybean. The architecture focuses on a Cloud based deployment model that uses AWS and Hugging Face Spaces to ensure worldwide access and scalability. The project is relevant to sustainable development goals (SDG 2: Zero Hunger) by ensuring data driven decision making which optimizes allocation of resources, reduces waste and improves production efficiency.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

Precision agriculture has converted the landscape of traditional models into more modern technology-driven predictive systems with the integration of new technologies such as Machine learning, Internet of Things, and cloud computing. Main goal of this section is to synthesize the main findings of the crop yield predictions, identifying the most common technological approach and define the research gap our work aims to fill.

A. Machine Learning Approaches for Yield Prediction

Early attempts at yield prediction were defined by various statistical methods and physiological models that were unable to capture the complex, nonlinear interactions characteristic of the ecosystem [1]. The Use of machine learning has provided the necessary tools to process high-dimensional, heterogeneous datasets.

Ensemble and Tree-Based Models: It has been shown in many studies that the performance of tree-based ensemble methods, such as Random Forest and Gradient Boosting, performing better than some simpler methods like MLR and

SVR [2]. One study about yield prediction showed more reliable results of RF models over SVR due to their resistance to noisiness and ability to handle non-linear feature interactions without complex normalization [3], [4]. First, the importance of features is built in by RF models, which helps the researchers identify most important factors such as soil NPK levels and rainfall patterns in that area [5]. According to H. B. Lee and J. Park, although Deep Learning models might perform well, they often are hard to understand and require much more data and computational resources than the optimized RF models for regional crop prediction [6]. This comparison justifies the use of Random Forest because it is a perfect trade-off between performance and resource use.

Model Optimization: Effective data preprocessing and hyperparameter tuning are often linked to higher accuracy [7]. Feature engineering is the crucial process of selecting the most influential variables from soil, weather, and historic records that is needed to simplify the model to the minimum, while achieving the best possible accuracy [8].

V. K. Singh and A. K. Jain pointed out that refining hyperparameters, such as the number of trees and maximum depth in an RF algorithm, is very essential. Plus, memorizing the training data-which is often a problem for smaller agricultural datasets-can be reduced [9].

B. Multi-Parameter Data Integration and IoT

We need to combine various data sets, way more than just simple climate inputs, for an accurate prediction of yield. Modern systems must include environmental, soil, and management practices.

Soil and Environmental Parameters: For real world systems, we need to include real-time or near real-time data from sensors. Work by J. Singh and P. Kaur showed that bringing together soil metrics, specifically NPK, pH, and organic carbon, together with meteorological data on temperature, humidity, and wind speed, significantly enhances the predictive power of the model [10]. B. Chen et al. were able to show that small changes in wind speed and atmospheric humidity, which is usually ignored in static models, may be crucial in localizing crop transpiration rate or disease risk, proving we need detailed of environmental features. More research on how to blend data suggests IoT-enabled multi-sensor setups to ensure continuous heterogeneous data flow and confirmed the idea of including multiple parameters from various data streams into one predictive model [12].

Synthesis: X. Liu and Y. Wang highlighted that the real challenge isn't gathering the data but in doing effective data preprocessing to handle missing values, sensor errors, and mismatched scales before feeding the inputs to the ML algorithm [13]. This thorough data integration process is a must have for reaching high accuracy targets, such as $R^2 > 0.95$ that move a system from a theoretical test to practical farm utility.

C. Cloud Computing and Deployment Architectures in Agriculture

Commercial agricultural AI tools require scalability, accessibility, and high availability, which are non-negotiable; meaning, we need cloud-based systems.

Cloud-Native Deployment: T. G. Kim and S. C. Lee mentioned AWS and similar cloud services as the foundation for large-scale agricultural monitoring systems [14]. They mentioned that cloud services, such as Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2) for model inference, Simple Storage Service (S3) for storing old and new data, provide elasticity to serve models to millions of users throughout the world [15]. A Cloud-Native approach has overcome the limitations imposed by servers or desktop applications. P. Smith and D. Jones mentioned the need for a Cloud-Native approach in precision agriculture to manage the growth of IoT and satellite imagery data and have loosely coupled computational power scale instantly with demand [16].

User Accessibility: A big reason on why these tools isn't used much of is how difficult the user interface is. R. H. Green and F. K. Bell noted that the most impactful ML applications use intuitive, web-based interfaces [17]. Recent work, such as the application of lightweight deployment frameworks like Gradio and Streamlit, made it much easier to start developing and sharing interactive ML dashboards, therefore providing the means to deliver high-end predictive analytics to regular users, such as farmers [18]. Employing such frameworks, often hosted on cloud services or dedicated ML sharing platforms, represents a change in democratizing agricultural AI [19]. The essence of such a user-centric deployment architecture is incredibly important, as it highlights two critical points in this research: practical implementation and adoption.

Research Gap: Although many studies confirm the superior accuracy of Random Forest and the power of cloud architecture, there still remains a gap in holistically integrating high accuracy, a multi-parameter model, with a cost-effective, easily deployable, and interactive cloud dashboard for both predictions and actionable recommendations [20]. This project specifically targets this integration and deployment gap by leveraging AWS for scalability and Gradio for accessibility to deliver a turnkey solution for yield optimization.

III. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

A. System Overview

The proposed system is constructed in a three-layered cloud architecture which are designed to provide accurate yield predictions. The framework contains data collection, computational analysis, and user interaction elements. This layered setup keeps the user interface separate from presentation layer which are responsible for the machine learning tasks and data layers who manages the information storage and retrieval processes.

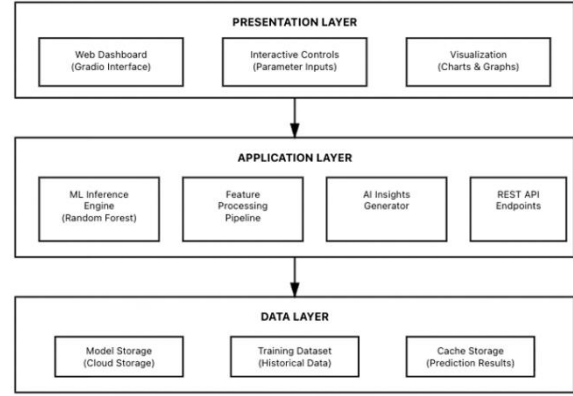


Figure 1: System Architecture Block Diagram

B. Algorithmic Framework

1. Core Prediction Algorithm

The primary predictive mechanism used is Random Forest Regression Algorithm. This method is mainly utilised because how it effectively handled the complex non-linear relationships within the agricultural data while still making it easier to interpret. The algorithm works by creating decision trees during training phase and then averaging the predictions thus helping to reduce the variance and prevents the overfitting issues that can arise during agricultural modeling.

2. Supplementary Techniques

Gradient Boosting methods are incorporated to make predictions more reliable and accurate. These techniques build the models sequentially, one after the other, with each subsequent model striving to correct the errors made by the preceding ones. By combining the Random Forest and Gradient Boosting, we end up with a robust ensemble that can pick up the overall trends from the dataset used and the finer variations in crop performance data

3. Feature Optimization

Feature engineering plays a vital role in how the models perform. The methodology involves a procedural examination of variable importance, consequently allowing the system to figure out the most influential parameter for the crop yield outcome. This process as well trims down less useful data while keeping the predictive accuracy intact; we therefore can speed up the processing time without losing any precision.

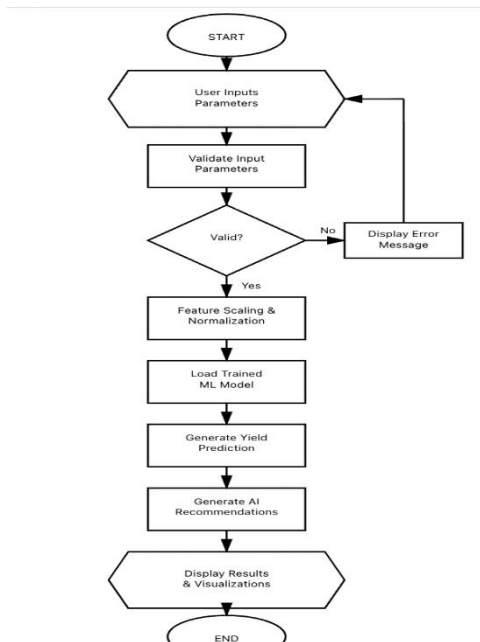


Figure 2: System Operation Flowchart

C. Data Acquisition and Processing

1. Input Parameters

The system contains three primary categories of agricultural data:

Environmental Factors: includes atmospheric conditions like the temperature(most influential), humidity, and wind velocity. These parameters help significantly to capture the growth conditions for the unpredictable environmental changes.

Soil Characteristics: We look at the data on nitrogen, phosphorus, and potassium levels along with the pH and the general soil health. This information gives us insight into the nutrients available for the crops.

Crop-Specific Information: The system distinguishes between five key crops -- wheat, corn, rice, barley, and soybean. Each of these crop types gets tailored attention in the model to reflect their specific growth needs and yield behaviors.

ID	Date	Crop_Type	Soil_Type	Soil_pH	Temperature	Humidity	Wind_Speed	N	P	K
1	2014-01-01	Wheat	Heavy	5.5	9.410294981650	80.8	19.105786559408	48.380000000000	45.0	27.5
2	2014-01-01	Corn	Loamy	6.5	26.85257454652	70.167463375967	8.7815786402151	34.0	66.0	58.0
3	2014-01-01	Rice	Heavy	5.5	12.143891171229	80.8	7.227731436706	71.5	54.0	33.5
4	2014-01-01	Barley	Sandy	5.75	11.7534541184	80.8	2.3324325548119	38.0	48.0	38.0
5	2014-01-01	Soybean	Heavy	5.5	10.1183194307023	80.8	7.29626784341707	49.5	45.0	33.5
6	2014-01-01	Cotton	Sandy	5.75	14.456751873662	80.8	19.365657495048	35.080000000000	44.0	36.0
7	2014-01-01	Sugarcane	Saltine	6.8	12.323884263286	80.8	9.51884642311007	34.5	66.0	54.0
8	2014-01-01	Tenette	Clay	5.25	11.332077731749	80.8	8.788839882435	48.0	45.0	46.0
9	2014-01-01	Pecota	Heavy	5.5	15.852981723275	80.8	6.5767867389585	48.380000000000	45.0	27.5

Fig3:Dataset

2. Data Preprocessing Pipeline

Before training the model, raw agricultural data goes through a thorough transformation process. The processing includes normalization the data to scale the features uniformly ,addressing the missing values through statistical imputations, and the removal of outliers as they could advestly effect the predictions.This standardization is crucial to maintain high data quality and enhance the models overall abilities.

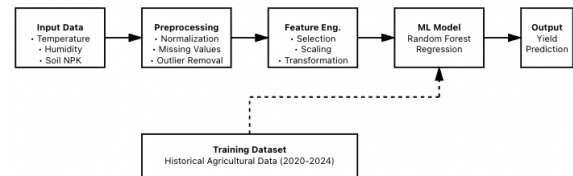


Figure 3: Data Processing Pipeline

D. Development Environment and Tools

1. Computational Infrastructure

The model training is conducted using Google Collabortary,which provides GPU accelerated computing resources which are greatly suitable for heavy machine learning tasks.This cloud-based development environment terminates the need for high-end local hardware while simultaneously enabling collaborative development workflows.

Focusing on the deployment segment, the system takes great advantage of the cloud computing services that offer scalable infrastructure. Storage solutions handle both raw datasets and trained model,therefore ensuring data persistence and version control throughout the development lifecycle.

2. Software Libraries and Frameworks

The implementation is through Python. Core data manipulation uses Pandas for tabular operations and Numpy for numerical tasks. Machine learning powered by Random Forest regression, KNN. The user interface component employed by Gradio, a framework specifically constructed to create interactive machine learning demonstrations. For data visualization, Chart.js and Plotly are adopted to create dynamic charts and graphs, as a result helps the user to see the prediction factors and how the model behaves.

3. Deployment Platform

Hugging Face Spaces serves as the installation platform, providing simplified deployment workflows with an incorporated version control system. This platform is mainly used due to its free hosting tiers, sufficient storage spaces

suitable for academic projects, while maintaining professional-grade reliability and performance.

IV. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The application created is a machine learning model that has been trained using a dataset sourced from Kaggle, which includes all the parameters necessary for yield prediction. These parameters consist of 1. environmental factors such as humidity, temperature, wind speed, and pH level; 2. nutrient content which involves nitrogen, phosphorus, and potassium; 3. crop and soil configurations that allow users to modify different crops and soil types, and it also features a soil quality score. All of these parameters can be easily customized through a user-friendly interface.

This model achieves an accuracy of 97.5% and has a root mean square error of 4.1, making it quite reliable. Users can adjust various factors to see the potential success measured in units/hectares. Through AI integration, it offers insights and recommendations based on the specified parameters and suggestions for improvement, assisting farmers in achieving a successful yield. The application also provides analyses that encompass crop yields over time, yield distribution by crop type, average yield categorized by region and crop type, and the top ten most significant factors. Furthermore, the application is hosted on a cloud platform utilizing Hugging Face Spaces, enhancing its utility and accessibility for all users. Experimental results reveal that the model is sensitive to changes in environmental parameters, hence estimating yield increases or decreases according to the given conditions. Multiple crops are supported, which testifies to its flexibility and practical usability.

V. CONCLUSION

Crop yield prediction is an ML based prediction system developed using concise Kaggle dataset which consists of environmental factors, soil nutrients, soil quality for various crops like wheat, maize etc. The model trained by Random Forest Regression and KNN was incorporated into a user friendly and interactive dashboard, which allows users to modify conditions such as NPK levels, temperature, humidity, pH levels and soil type with respect to crops.

This system generates real time yield predictions along with insights from an LLM model enabling farmers and stakeholders to make right and accurate decisions. The results also indicate, the model's effectiveness in estimating yield under multiple agricultural conditions and enhancing the usability of the predictive analysis in farming industry.

VI. FUTURE SCOPE:

Further future scope for this system is by incorporating real time IoT sensor data, satellite image processing and weather APIs to achieve consistent live predictions.

More advanced models can be incorporated like Deep learning, transformer-based architectures which have high scope in improving accuracy. The dashboard can also be scaled down into a mobile application and integrated with geolocation-based soil databases, fertilizer advisory systems and early risk detection for pests, diseases and drought. These enhancements would strengthen the model's real-world applicability and support sustainable, technology driven agriculture.

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